Practitioner of Economic Management in Rajasthan

India lives in states. Constitutionally, the states are also the pivot to deliver development programmes and administer the laws of the land. As an IAS officer of the Rajasthan cadre, I implemented policies, programmes, laws and executive orders of the government in the state, many of which were in the economic space.

As a subdivisional officer in Chittorgarh, I could see agriculture land management at close quarters. As the chief executive officer of a World Bank-funded soybean processing project in Kota, I turned around a sick ‘white elephant’. Later, I got the opportunity to work in the agriculture sector for many years as the director of agriculture in Rajasthan and joint secretary in the Ministry of Agriculture, Government of India.

My service in Rajasthan for the fifteen years before 2000, offered the rich experience of working in several significant infrastructure, industrial and service sectors of the economy. As chief executive of the Rajasthan Renewables Management Agency, I could participate in the development of the nascent solar and wind power generation sector, including formulation of the wind and solar policies of the state. I played a role in the unbundling of the vertically integrated Rajasthan Electricity Board into separate generation, transmission and distribution companies, which initiated my extensive association with the power sector. I participated in policy development relating to important education sector programmes, including dealing with the private and aided educational sector.

I served as secretary (finance), in charge of the Budget Division, in Rajasthan for about two years. I also served as principal secretary in charge of the entire Finance Department of Rajasthan twice: first in 2008 and then in 2014. The Finance Department provided the most wide-angled view of the entire economic, social and governance management of the state. The making of two budgets in 2006–08 and the formulation of two budgets (including one interim) in 2014 provided enormous insight into the working